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Correct
Answer

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Practice Exam - 1

Question 4 of 117



A 64-year-old male with a history of HTN, DM, carpal tunnel syndrome s/p release and MGUS presents with abdominal bloating and shortness of breath. EKG reveals NSR with nonspecific ST changes. Echocardiography reveals LVH with preserved LVEF and no significant valvular regurgitation. Cardiac MRI reveals elevated native T1 and elevated ECV with a diffuse pattern concerning for cardiac amyloid.

Question Line: What is the appropriate next step in the evaluation process ?

- A. Technetium-99m pyrophosphate scintigraphy (PYP) scan
- ☒ B. Obtain serum kappa/lambda free light chain ratio and serum and urine IFE
- C. Obtain endomyocardial biopsy
- D. Obtain a PET/CT

Commentary

References

Testing Point: The Board-certified AHFTC specialist should know the diagnostic evaluation process for cardiac amyloidosis.

Correct Answer: B. Obtain serum kappa/lambda free light chain ratio and serum and urine IFE

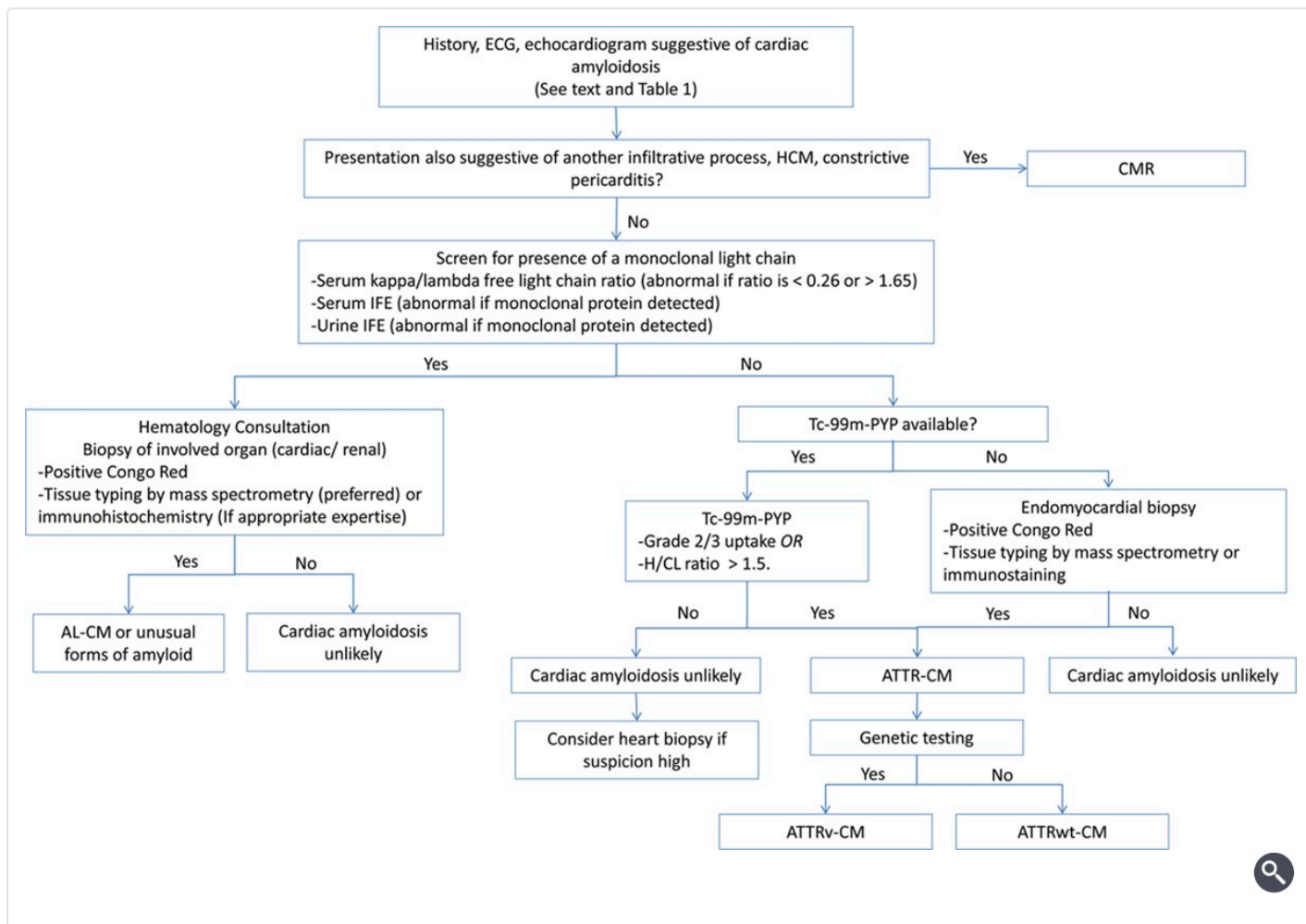
Rationale: The appropriate next step in the evaluation process is to screen for presence of a monoclonal light chain using serum kappa/lambda as well as urine and serum IFE. If this testing is positive then the diagnostic algorithm recommends hematology consultation and biopsy of involved organs. If this testing is negative, then the next step in the evaluation

process is to obtain a Technetium-99m pyrophosphate scintigraphy (PYP) scan.

Answer A: PYP scan is an appropriate step in the diagnostic evaluation of amyloid heart disease, but should be completed if light chain testing is negative.

Answer C: Endomyocardial biopsy is not the correct next step in the algorithm but can be considered if PYP scan is unavailable or if diagnostic uncertainty remains.

Answer D: PET/CT is not part of the diagnostic algorithm for cardiac amyloid.



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